territories held by the Bengal sultan Nair al-din Nusrat Shah. Nusrat Shah welcomed all these Afghan warriors, happy for them to set up a buffer zone in Bihar between the alarmingly expansionist Mughals and Bengal. One Taj Khan Karrani had set up a dynasty in that buffer zone, all the while keeping a keen lookout on events unfolding in Delhi. A descendant of Taj Khan, Daud Khan Afghan, would no longer be so cowed by Mughal power and would rise to challenge Akbar.

For the next few years Akbar would confront all these enemies in battle, for to fail to do so would be to fail his destiny and his Timurid legacy. At the same time, Akbar would carefully forge a composite identity for Mughal noblemen so that their dangerous clan allegiances would be diffused. But first, with Rajasthan now secure within the Mughal Empire, and the way thus cleared all the way to the Arabian Sea, Akbar set off to conquer Gujarat.

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*Central Asian region comprising modern-day Uzbekistan, Tajikistan, and parts of Kazakhstan.
*Of the household of Mary.
†Mary of the World.
*Muzaffar Khan Turbati. Akbar later revoked the order.
*The hereditary registrar of landed property in a subdivision of a district.
†A cultivator.